

Jacob Darling

Strategic Marketing Technologist | Automation Architect | SEO/SEM + CRM + AI Systems

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Professional Summary

Creative and data-driven marketing technologist with 16+ years of experience leading full-stack marketing strategies and building scalable automation systems that drive real business results.

I specialize in marketing architecture—from CRM and email automation (FluentCRM, HubSpot, Zapier) to paid media strategy (Google Ads, Meta, LinkedIn) and SEO/SEM optimization. I bring a hybrid skill set that connects strategy, content, technology, and analytics.

At Graston Technique®, I built an automation system with 400+ workflows, reducing support tickets by 70% and increasing checkout conversions by 40%. I've led digital growth campaigns, developed LMS integrations, and architected systems serving 30,000+ users globally across healthcare, SaaS, legal, and fintech sectors.

With a passion for converting complexity into clarity, I bring energy, creativity, and executional muscle to every project. I'm currently seeking fractional leadership roles, contract partnerships, or full-time opportunities where strategic marketing and systems thinking intersect.

✉ Contact: hoosierdarling@gmail.com

🌐 Portfolio: bearcavemarketing.com

Willing to relocate: Anywhere

Authorized to work in the US for any employer

Work Experience

Marketing Director

Graston Technique, LLC-Indianapolis, IN

August 2023 to Present

Marketing Director → Director of Marketing Systems & Strategy

- **System Architecture:** Built an integrated ecosystem with LearnDash LMS, WooCommerce, WP Fusion, Gravity Forms, Uncanny Automator, and FluentCRM. Architected "Buy Now, Choose Later" credit system for training bundles and CEU Short access. Launched tiered provider directory with analytics dashboards and premium profile upsell paths.
- **AI & Automation:** Built and deployed a GPT-powered assistant connected to the site via REST APIs to assist with CEU rules, order lookups, training suggestions, and user escalation. Used Uncanny Automator and WP Fusion to build 400+ automations triggered by tags, training progress, or form submissions.
- **Analytics & Dashboards:** Created provider analytics dashboards syncing GA4 data via GTM and Analytify. Displays page views, link clicks, social metrics, UTM sources, and benchmark comparisons with admin override and export options.
- **Performance & DevOps:** Optimized site speed with WP Rocket, LiteSpeed, Cloudflare CDN, async/defer scripts, GTM server-side tagging. Built REST-based frontend dashboards with Cloudflare Workers + Mapbox for training event coordination. Implemented comprehensive performance and security measures including:
- **Cloudflare Optimizations:** Rate-limiting, WAF rules, Bot Fight Mode, Caching & Tiered Cache, Managed Transforms, Page Rules, SSL/TLS Origin Cert, DNSSEC Setup (including GoDaddy DS Submission).

- Server & WordPress Enhancements: Compression (Brotli + gzip), Browser Caching, Security Headers, Cookie-Free CDN, LiteSpeed CDN Mapping & Optimizations, WP Rocket Page Cache, Liquid Web PHP Limits, PHP-FPM Optimization, PHP 8.3 Upgrade (Staging), WP Dashboard Clean-up, Cron & Heartbeat Tuning, ESI / Role-Vary Cache.
- Monitoring & Recovery: Netdata Monitoring & Alerts, Critical Error Recovery, Server Resource Review, Liquid Web PHP Handler Update.
- Code & Database Maintenance: Search & Replace Cleanup, Autoloaded Options Cleanup, JS Optimization (WP Rocket), Asset Optimization, Font & DNS Preload Fixes, Preload Cache Fix, Apache Tuning, Cloudflare Beacon & SRI Fix, Umami Analytics Endpoint Correction, Divi Module Refactor, Translation Handling (WP 6.7 Ready).
- Team Leadership: Manages cross-functional sprints with developers, designers, instructors, and marketing associates. Translates business goals into dev-ready specifications and user-friendly UX flows.
- Tracking & Conversion: Implemented Form Submission Tracking (Gravity Forms / GTM / Google Ads), GTM Engagement Tracking, GTM Preview Auth Setup, GTM v28 Cleanup & GA4 Only, Google Ads Conversion Optimization, Lead Conversion Event, OptinMonster Conversion Integration, Google Ads Conversion Configuration, PixelYourSite Pro: Tracking & Ads Sync.
- Instructor Tools & Integrations: Dynamic "e3vent" Map Integration, Google Maps API Key Lockdown, Instructor Dashboard: Event Filtering, Instructor Dashboard: Instrument Visibility.
- Platform Development: LearnDash Multisite Planning.

Interim Director of Marketing

Ultimate Technologies Group-Fishers, IN

February 2023 to June 2023

- Spearheaded marketing strategy and execution during a key transitional period, ensuring business continuity and brand consistency across all channels.
- Managed end-to-end marketing communications, including internal messaging, external campaigns, and stakeholder engagement.
- Led the development and optimization of Google Ads campaigns, improving lead generation, CTR, and overall ROI.
- Oversaw content creation for website, email marketing, social media, and sales collateral to support business development initiatives.
- Coordinated with cross-functional teams (sales, customer success, executive leadership) to align marketing strategy with organizational goals.
- Implemented marketing automation workflows and CRM integrations to streamline operations and enhance campaign performance tracking.
- Conducted market research and competitive analysis to refine targeting and positioning strategies.
- Managed and optimized paid media and SEO efforts, driving qualified traffic and enhancing online visibility.
- Directed branding updates and ensured visual and messaging alignment across all customer touchpoints.
- Provided leadership and mentoring to the marketing team, ensuring high performance during organizational change.

Marketing Manager

Riley Bennett Egloff, LLP-Indianapolis, IN

June 2015 to March 2023

Marketing Manager → Strategic Marketing Lead – Legal Sector

- Experienced in strategic marketing, digital communications, and client development for legal and professional services.
- Designed, built, and managed comprehensive marketing materials, including brochures, advertisements, email campaigns, newsletters, social media content, and RBE magazines.
- Oversaw firm branding and content strategy across digital platforms, including full ownership of the RBE website—enhancing performance, SEO, and user experience.
- Led public and media relations efforts: cultivated media relationships, drafted press releases, and secured firm publicity in legal news, thought leadership, and client matters.

- Created and executed direct email marketing and social media campaigns; tracked performance metrics and optimized results.
- Partnered with attorneys to develop and manage individualized business development plans—successfully identifying new opportunities for client engagement and growth.
- Developed strategic pitch materials and managed RFP/proposal responses, showcasing firm capabilities with precision and impact.
- Played a key role in industry submissions and award nominations, increasing firm visibility and market recognition.
- Provided market intelligence insights to guide future strategy and business development planning.
- Actively participated in practice group meetings, contributing actionable insights that drove firm-wide initiatives forward.
- Established trusted relationships with practice group leaders and attorneys to support cross-selling and firm-wide business growth.

Marketing Coordinator

Deerfield Financial Advisors-Indianapolis, IN

June 2013 to June 2015

- Executed marketing initiatives and campaigns to elevate brand awareness and attract new clients while supporting ongoing engagement with existing clients and professional partners.
- Planned and managed successful client-facing seminars and events, enhancing client retention and brand credibility.
- Wrote and maintained content for the company website, email marketing campaigns, and printed collateral, ensuring consistency and clarity in brand messaging.
- Researched, evaluated, and implemented new technology platforms, improving both client services and internal operational efficiency.
- Collaborated with the Chief Compliance Officer to review all marketing materials, ensuring full compliance with FINRA and SEC regulations.

Marketing Coordinator

Pike Medical Consultants-Indianapolis, IN

January 2009 to December 2013

- Directed all marketing functions for the organization, including strategic planning, budgeting, advertising, branding, public relations, website development, and event management, while reporting directly to the company president.
- Drove a 45% increase in patient visits over three years, maintaining a consistently positive ROI across all marketing initiatives.
- Designed and executed integrated marketing and advertising campaigns that directly contributed to sustained company growth.
- Led the creation of a new company website, modernizing the digital presence and improving patient engagement and lead generation.
- Developed and managed internal and external communication strategies to strengthen brand positioning and market visibility.
- Oversaw public relations efforts to increase awareness and credibility in the healthcare community.
- Implemented data-driven tracking and evaluation processes to measure the effectiveness of campaigns and inform future strategy.

Education

Business Management (Bachelor's degree)

Indiana University-Bloomington-Bloomington, IN

August 2004 to May 2008

Bachelor of Marketing

Skills

- Research
- Customer retention strategy
- Public Relations
- Microsoft Excel
- SaaS platforms
- Marketing consultant experience
- Data analytics tools
- Experimental design
- Analysis skills
- HubSpot CRM
- Nielsen
- Director experience
- GitHub
- Team development
- Adobe Premiere Pro
- Marketing strategy development
- Paid search advertising campaigns
- Content Management
- Microsoft PowerPoint
- SEO
- Click-through rate (CTR) improvement
- Google Ad Words
- Constant Contact
- E-commerce
- Change management
- Adobe Photoshop
- Continuous improvement
- Bing Ads
- CRM Workflows
- Android development
- Documentation review
- Innovation
- Case studies
- Omniture
- Managing marketing teams - Largest marketing team managed (6-10 team members)
- Decision Making

- Excel data analysis
- Marketing automation tools
- Conversion tracking
- Go-to-market strategy
- Marketing case studies
- Podcasts for digital marketing
- B2B sales
- Performance dashboard reports
- Blogging
- Content marketing
- SEO/SEM Strategy
- Marketo
- WordPress
- Web Design
- Event marketing
- Market research
- Responsive design
- Customer surveys
- Marketing ROI (MROI) improvement
- Pardot
- Financial management
- Data Integration (Data management)
- Application Integration
- Salesforce
- Vite
- Cross-functional collaboration
- Customer acquisition
- B2B
- Cost per click (CPC) reduction
- Technical marketing team management - Largest technical marketing team managed (6-10 team members)
- Cross-functional team management
- Influencer marketing
- Partnership marketing
- Adobe InDesign
- Content Development
- SEMrush
- Problem Solving
- TikTok
- Market Analysis
- Google Ads

- Photography
- Power BI
- SEM
- Web analytics
- Visual design
- Marketing director experience
- Content marketing strategy
- Implementing marketing automation tools
- Customer lifetime value (CLV) growth
- Customer retention rate increase
- Content writing
- Adobe Analytics
- Demand generation marketing
- UX design
- Social media marketing
- Basecamp
- Fair Housing regulations
- Data management
- Demand planning
- SQL
- HTML5
- Zapier
- Mentoring
- Hospitality
- Task prioritization
- Direct marketing
- Data collection
- Managing marketing project budgets - Largest marketing project budget managed (\$500,000-\$1M)
- Team management
- Web Development
- Data interpretation
- Canva
- Salesforce Cloud
- Multichannel marketing
- Sports marketing
- Financial services
- Confluence
- Sales pipeline management
- Negotiation
- Video production

- Supervising experience
- Advertising sales
- Google Workspace
- Attention to detail
- Marketing Mix
- Information management
- Keyword research
- Sales
- Strategic Planning
- Operations management
- Tailwind CSS
- Private equity
- DNS
- Project management software
- Copywriting
- Conflict management
- SharePoint
- SaaS
- Information Architecture
- Customer journey mapping
- Web analytics reporting
- Marketing campaign budget management
- Proofreading
- Manufacturing
- Facebook Advertising
- Marketing - Marketing experience (16-20 years)
- AI
- Databases
- Dashboard development
- Presentation skills
- APIs
- PPC Campaign Management
- Marketing mix modeling
- Communication skills
- Google Search Console
- Project leadership
- Leadership
- Cross-functional communication
- Pay-per-click (PPC) advertising
- Marketing project management

- Paid search marketing
- Analytics
- Martech
- Google Analytics
- Product-Led Growth
- Hootsuite
- Revenue growth
- Competitive analysis
- Managing marketing, advertising or public relations teams
- Brand manager experience
- Managing budgets in a finance role
- Marketing analytics
- Pricing strategies
- Marketing coordinator experience
- ServiceNow
- Adobe Illustrator
- User Experience (UX)
- Forecasting
- Project management
- Business intelligence
- Social media advertising
- Zoominfo
- Events Management
- Creative Thinking
- Mailchimp
- Usability testing
- Video editing
- Performance marketing
- A/B testing
- SEM campaigns
- UI design
- Pivot tables
- Marketing operations
- Google Tag Manager
- B2B marketing
- Brand awareness strategy
- Attribution modeling
- Event planning
- CSS
- Google AdWords

- Adobe After Effects
- Predictive analysis
- Adobe Lightroom
- English
- Content strategy and information architecture team management - Content strategy and information architecture team management (7-10 team members)
- Sports coaching
- React
- Adobe Creative Suite
- Agile
- Adobe Express
- Management
- SEO tools
- Product management
- Print advertising
- Product marketing
- Social media strategy
- Data analysis skills
- Adobe Experience Manager
- Lead generation
- SQL databases
- Conversion rates analysis
- Search engines
- CRM software
- Data analytics
- Video marketing
- Account management
- IT
- Home health
- Jira
- Mobile marketing
- Bounce rate reduction
- UI development
- Design
- Data-driven decision making
- Program management
- Stakeholder engagement
- Vendor relationship building
- Social media management
- Trello
- Data reporting

- Data visualization
- Tableau
- iOS
- Project planning
- Content creation
- Salesforce Marketing Cloud
- Microsoft Office
- Sales management systems proficiency
- Content management systems
- Senior leadership
- Media buying
- Google Docs
- Integrated marketing
- Software deployment
- Customer service
- Paid advertising campaign management
- Motion graphics
- Budgeting
- Marketing & Communications
- User Interface (UI)
- CRM system proficiency
- AdRoll
- Graphic design
- Organizational skills
- YouTube
- Adobe Acrobat
- Customer relationship management
- Marketing automation
- Customer segmentation
- JavaScript
- Lead generation campaigns
- Smartsheet
- Relationship management
- Email marketing campaigns
- Conversion optimization
- Email marketing
- Technical Proficiency
- Growth marketing strategy
- Content strategy
- HubSpot

- Website design projects
- Marketing manager experience
- Affiliate marketing
- Slack
- Business development
- Branding
- Behavioral segmentation
- Stakeholder management
- Marketing intern experience
- Digital marketing
- Email open rate improvement
- Team motivation (leadership skill)
- Customer retention
- UI Testing
- Audio advertising
- ActiveCampaign
- Social media advertising campaigns
- Product marketing strategy
- Marketing specialist experience

Languages

- English - Fluent
- Spanish - Beginner

Links

[linkedin.com/in/JacobDarling](https://www.linkedin.com/in/JacobDarling)

JacobDarling.MyPortfolio.com

Awards

Scholastic Art & Writing: Gold Key Award - Photography

March 2004

Awarded to Jacob Darling for outstanding achievement in photography, demonstrating exceptional artistic vision, originality, and technical proficiency in the Regional Scholastic Art Awards.

The Gold Key represents the highest regional honor, placing recipients among the top 5% of emerging young artists nationwide. This recognition is a testament to creative excellence and potential for future contributions to the arts.

Certifications and Licenses

Driver's License

Publications

Jacob Darling's Marketing Portfolio | 16+ Yrs in Growth, Branding & Digital Strategy

<https://www.bearcavemarketing.com/>

November 2025

A curated showcase of my 16+ years of experience in marketing leadership, creative strategy, and digital execution. The site includes case studies, campaign samples, branding work, social media strategy, event marketing, and web development projects across B2B SaaS, healthcare, and professional services.

Key highlights:

- Demand generation and pipeline growth strategies
- Content development for email, web, and social platforms
- Paid media campaign performance and ROI metrics
- Marketing automation and CRM integration (Marketo, Salesforce)
- Event activations and sponsorship recaps
- Creative assets including ads, video, and web design

This portfolio reflects a data-driven, results-focused approach to full-funnel marketing.

Additional Information

President - School 80 Condominiums Homeowners Association

Oct 2019 - Oct 2022

- Provide leadership and oversight for HOA operations, budgets, community relations, and strategic initiatives to enhance property value and resident experience.
- Represent homeowners in key decisions, enforce bylaws, and manage vendor and board communications.

Board Member - School 80 Condominiums Homeowners Association

Dec 2015 - Oct 2019

- Support board governance, help manage financial planning, maintenance, and community policies.

Board Member - Primary Colours

Jan 2018 - Dec 2019

- Supported the mission to connect visual artists with the community through events, exhibitions, and programming.
- Facilitated community interaction and strategic planning for growth of the local art scene.

Business Mentor - SMART - Anti-Bullying Program at School #96

Jan 2013 - May 2013

- Mentored students in developing a business and marketing plan for their anti-bullying initiative, encouraging leadership, teamwork, and creative problem-solving.

Marketing Volunteer - Frances W. Parker IPS School 56

Jun 2017

- Designed a series of 12 custom posters for the school's Situational VALUES project promoting character development and student values.

Event Volunteer - Walk to Defeat ALS - Indianapolis

Aug 2016

- Assisted with event setup, marketing materials, and onsite logistics to support fundraising and awareness efforts for ALS research.

Graphic Designer (Volunteer) - Eastwood Middle School Women's Soccer Team

Jan 2017

- Designed and produced team t-shirts to support school spirit and team identity.